The next day, we wake up to Australian newspaper headlines calling them a ‘disgrace’ and, in *The Advertiser*’s case, ‘Aussie cricket’s day of shame’. It is unusual to sense the Australian cricket world warring with itself – it has always, until this morning, seemed so unified, resolute and sure.

We win the Ashes in Australia in Sydney – the first English team to do so in 24 years. I end up as the highest wicket taker, standing behind Swanny and doing the sprinkler in front of the jubilant travelling support. When the teams disperse, we sit on the outfield, the beautiful Sydney Cricket Ground, and share stories about what has just happened over the last couple of months – from Bavaria to here. The first thing I do is not party into the night, but sleep. It’s been the most emotional seven weeks of my life. It’s been full of worry, silliness, loneliness, community, profound moments of meaning, success, failure and ultimately now in my burn out, sickness, but most importantly, a historical achievement. It’s the best I have ever bowled, in the hardest place to do it, while the most is going through my mind outside. Sometimes it happens like that – absolutely everything, all at the same time – too much to pin down or make sense of, just the entire spectrum of life thrown in your lap to see how you deal with it. All I could do was cling on, keep trying to bowl well. When I get home, Ruby is a few weeks old. I haven’t seen her since she was born.